



PSYC1003

Psychopathology & the Birth of Psychotherapy

Part 3: Hysteria, Hypnosis & Psychological Treatment

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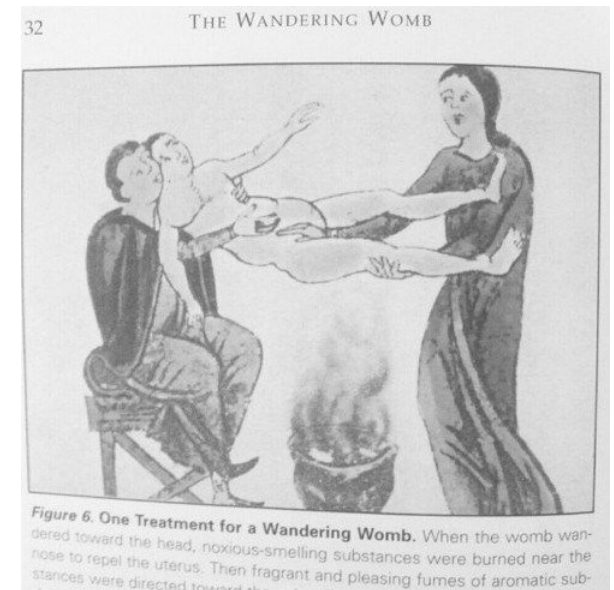
Hysteria in Europe

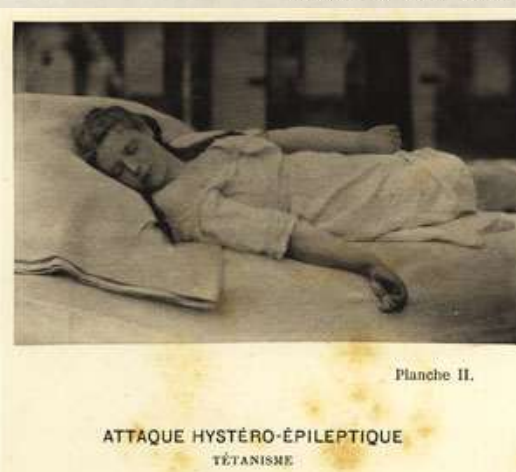
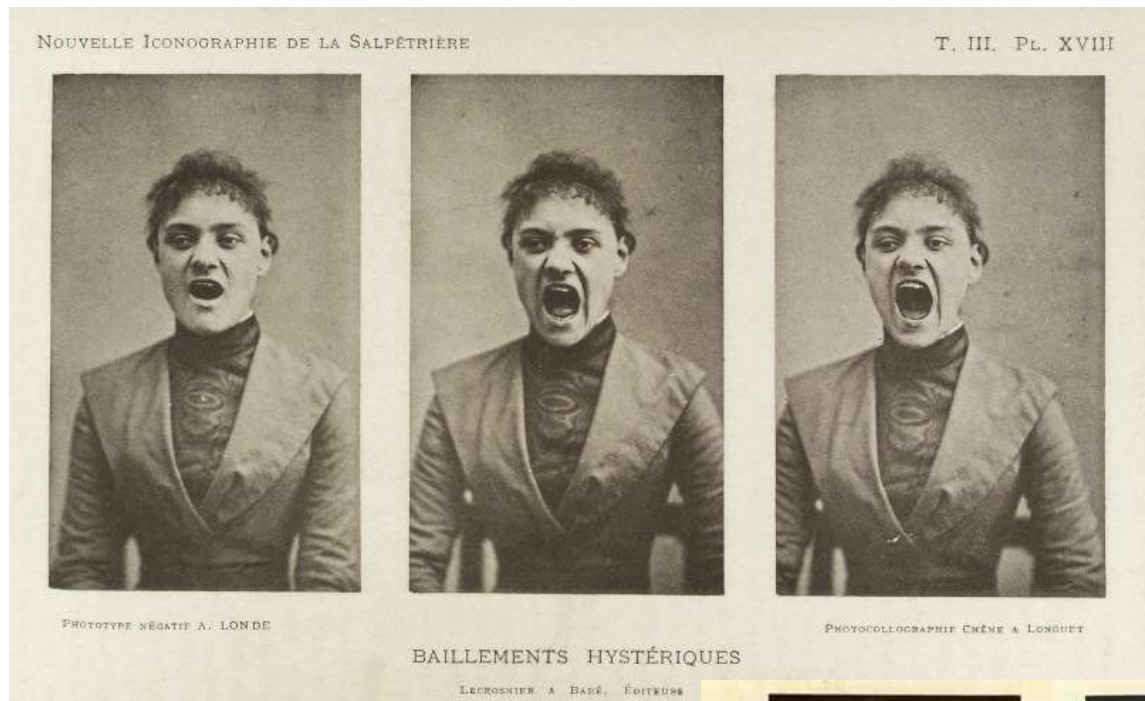
1800s: Large numbers of women suffering from 'hysteria' (*Hysteria*: womb)

- Ancient Greek diagnosis (5-4 BCE)
- Plato: wandering womb
- Galen: caused by sexual deprivation

Wide range of symptoms:

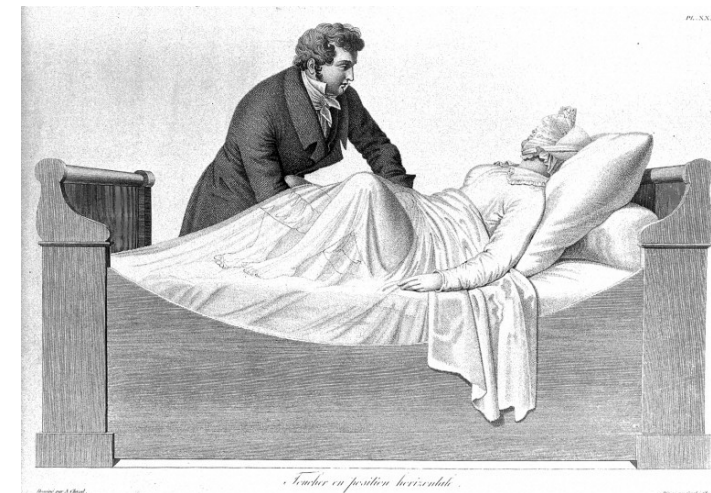
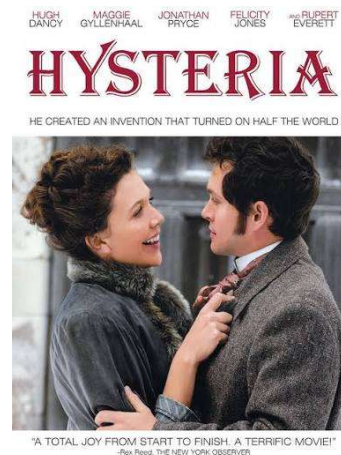
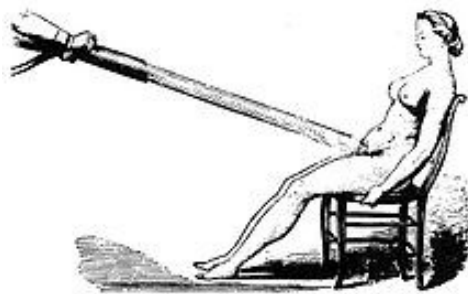
- Paralyzes, convulsions, motor tics
- Amnesia, excitability, dissociated states
- 'Nervous disorder'





Hysteria in the Victorian era

- Social construction of disorders
- 'Female weakness'
- Treatment: **hysterical paroxysm**
- *Penis normalis dosim repetatur*
- Sexual intercourse (if married), pelvic (vaginal) massage



"FEMALE WEAKNESS."

Mrs. WILLIAM HOOVER, of Bellville, Richland Co., Ohio, writes: "I had been a great sufferer from 'female weakness,' I tried three doctors; they did me no good; I thought I was an invalid forever. But I heard of Dr. Pierce's Favorite Prescription, and then I wrote to him and he told me just how to take it. I took eight bottles. I now feel entirely well. I could stand on my feet only a short time, and now I do all my work for my family of five."



MRS. HOOVER.

FEMALE WEAKNESS.

INDIGESTION, HEADACHE, INSOMNIA.

A SYDNEY LADY CURED.

In this trying climate of ours the woman who is exempt from troubles peculiar to her sex is a great exception. Mrs. Mosser, of "Glenbrook," No. 6 Union-street, Erskineville, Sydney, is no exception to the rule. To a reporter a few days ago who interviewed her she said:—"For several years I have had terrible bursting headaches, throbbing in the temples, indigestion, dizziness, insomnia, and various other ailments, the results of female ailments. I became so ill that I went for a course of outdoor treatment at the Prince Alfred Hospital. Here I was treated for acute indigestion and severe headaches,

"Nervous exhaustion—blinding headache"



Striving to satisfy the demands of everyone is

apt to affect the nerves, and continual standing may weaken the Heart.

Dr. Miles' Nervine

LIVED IN MISERY.

"I suffered greatly from nervousness and headaches. The least excite-

FOR ALL FEMALE DISEASES.

THIS IS
ACKNOWLEDGED
AS ONE OF

THE
GREATEST
REMEDIES

OF THE AGE.

A GREAT BLOOD PURIFIER AND NERVE TONIC.



Peoria. from your druggist.

If you suffer distress from
Monthly **FEMALE WEAKNESS**

Which Makes You Blue, Cranky
NERVOUS—

At such times if you're troubled by cramps, headache, backache, a bloated feeling, nervousness—distress of "irregularities"—due to functional monthly disturbances—try Lydia E. Pinkham's Vegetable Compound! It's helped thousands upon thousands of women and girls to go "smiling thru" such "difficult days."

Lydia Pinkham's Compound is one medicine you can buy today—made especially for women—to relieve monthly pain and its tired nervous feelings due to this cause. And in such a sensible way! With nature's own beneficial roots and herbs. No harmful opiates.

Taken regularly—thruout the month—Pinkham's Compound helps build up resistance against such symptoms. Follow label directions. Worth trying!



HONEST DAD! ALL I SAID
WAS SCHOOL HOLIDAYS!!



These Hysterical Women

CRYING . . . sobbing . . . laughing! She has no control of herself . . . the slightest thing drives her to distraction. Tired all the time . . . overwrought . . . nerves strung to the breaking point. Constant headache, backache, and dizzy spells are robbing this woman of youth, beauty and health.

If she would only give Lydia E. Pinkham's Vegetable Compound a chance to

help her. How well and happy she might be.

The tablet form is so easy to take. Send fifty cents to the Lydia E. Pinkham Medicine Company, 1172 Cleveland St., Lynn Massachusetts for a bottle which sells regularly for \$1.50. Let us prove that this medicine can do for you what it has done for other suffering women.

Try Lydia E. Pinkham's Vegetable Compound Tablet Form



"Is she dead?" I asked.

"She just fainted, Arlo," Andrea said.

"Whenever a girl faints in the movies," I said, "somebody slaps her in the face and she wakes up."

"You should slap her, A.J.," said Michael.

"I said, 'I'll

Towards Psychological treatments



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Franz Anton Mesmer (1734-1815)

- Viennese physician who moved to Paris
- Disease results from intangible 'fluid' penetrating the entire universe

Psychological problems: Treat with 'animal magnetism'

- Attempted to have a 'scientific' basis
- Empirical demonstrations of cure





The rise of hypnosis

James Braid (1795-1860)

- Sceptical of magnetism
- **Concentration & suggestibility**
- Mesmerism transformed into 'neuro-hypnotism' (Gk: *hypnos*: sleep) (c. 1845)
- **Founder of 'hypnosis'**

France: rise in interest in hypnosis to treat
'hysterics'



Hypnosis in France

Salpêtrière Hospital in Paris

Jean Charcot (1825-1893)

- Neurologist (*Charcot's disease*)
- Worked mainly with 'hysterics'

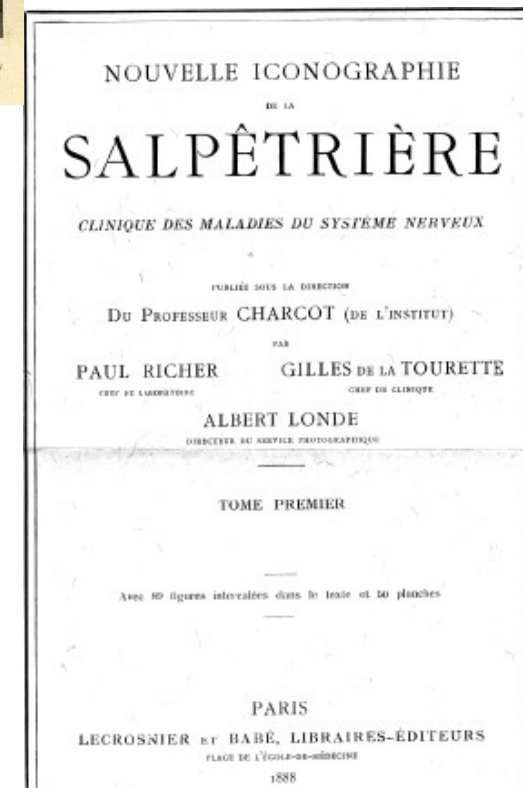
Hysteria

- Inherited neurological degeneracy
- *Hysteroid personalities* (predisposition)
- **Trauma & dissociation** (Ψ 'cal factor)
- 'Splitting' of the mind

Hypnotic state: something abnormal & pathological



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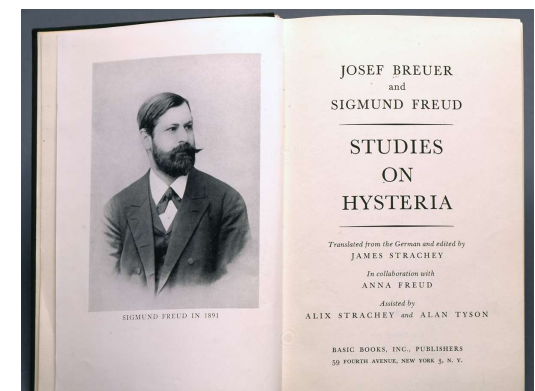




Emergence of Dynamic Depth Psychology (late 1800s)

- a) **Pierre Janet** (1859-1949)
- b) **Sigmund Freud** (1856-1939)

- Both trained by Charcot
- Both focus on psychological causes
- Both initially see **traumatic experience** as causal
- Both see hypnosis as therapeutic tool



Emergence of Dynamic Depth Psychology (late 1800s)



Janet: trauma & exhaustion

- The individual lacks sufficient mental energy to keep the mind integrated after trauma
- *Dissociative states & 'subconscious'*

Freud: trauma & defense

- Rejected inherited degeneracy view
- Psychopathology arises from avoiding traumatic memories
- *Repression & the unconscious*



The birth of psychotherapy

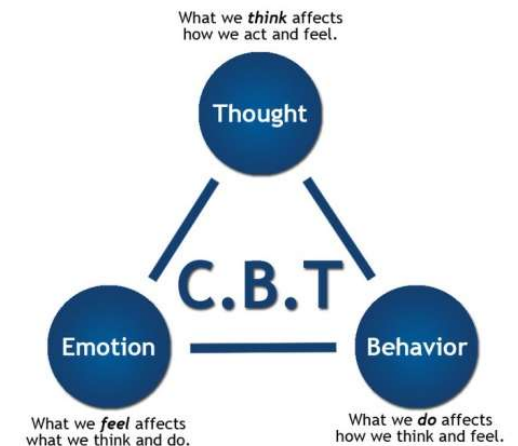
- Importance of unconscious processes (but not original to Freud)
- **Talking cure** & free association
- **Aim:** making the unconscious conscious
- Freud abandons hypnosis
- Emergence of *Psychological* therapy



The birth of psychotherapy

Proliferation of bio/behavioural/psychological treatments

- Psychiatry & biological processes
- Behavioural therapy
- Cognitive-Behavioural therapy (CBT)
- Client-centered therapy (Rogers, 1961)





Reflective Summary

- History indicates that our ideas about mental disorder are shaped by cultural beliefs & social values of a particular historical period

Seen also in current debates:

- DSM revisions
- Neurodiversity debates
- Cross-cultural diagnosis
- What assumptions in our current models might future psychologists consider misguided?



Questions?

